Chapter 1

Installing Rails

In Part I of this book, we'll introduce you to both the Ruby language and the Rails framework. But we can't get anywhere until you've installed both and verified that they're operating correctly.

To get Rails running on your system, you need the following:

- A Ruby interpreter. Rails is written in Ruby, and you'll be writing your applications in Ruby too. Rails 7 will run on Ruby version 2.7, 3.0, and 3.1. It won't work on prior versions of Ruby.
- Ruby on Rails. This book was written using Rails version 7 (specifically, Rails 7.0.4).
- Some libraries, depending on the operating system.
- A database. We're using SQLite 3 in this book.

For a development machine, that's about all you'll need (apart from an editor, and we'll talk about editors separately). However, if you're going to deploy your application, you'll also need to install a production web server (as a minimum) along with some support code to let Rails run efficiently.

You can also install everything in a virtual machine. This can be good to isolate your Rails environment from your actual computer, though it will require a fair amount of disk space.